

MCDONNELL DOUGLAS MD-90 DIFFERENCES FROM MD-80

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Updated: 5/31/2026

Note: This guide is not an FCOM and does not describe every single behavior of the system.

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INTRODUCTION

There is little information on the systems and operation of the MD-90 available. As such, this document is intended to describe the MD-90 differences for pilots familiar with its predecessor, the MD-80.

The MD-90 is very similar to the MD-80 but has several changes to systems. The MD-90 Enhanced Flight Deck (EFD) contains further differences.

AUTOFLIGHT AND DFGS

AUTOMATIC THRUST RESTORATION

On the MD-80, the difference in engine indications for the Automatic Thrust Restoration (ATR) system to activate is 0.25 EPR or 7% N1.

On the MD-90, a difference of 0.1 EPR or 14% N1 is needed.

Other conditions required for ATR to activate are identical.

FLIGHT MODE ANNUNCIATOR

The MD-80 and standard MD-90 Flight Mode Annunciator (FMA) is its own instrument.

The MD-90 EFD FMA is located on the top of the Primary Flight Display. Certain mode names are expanded when compared to the MD-80 due to additional room for characters. For example, "RETD" is displayed as the full mode name, "RETARD".

MACH TRIM

The MD-80 Digital Flight Guidance System (DFGS) adjusts the first officer's yoke neutral position backwards to counteract mach tuck (nose down effect).

On the MD-90, Mach Trim is accomplished via nose up stabilizer commands directly from DFGS. This position offset is removed as the aircraft slows.

PERFORMANCE AND VNAV

MD-80s equipped with a Performance Management System (PMS) have a "PERF" button on the Flight Guidance Control Panel (FGCP). PMS modes are available on the Autoflight system.

On the MD-90, PMS is not installed. The FGCP has "VNAV" and "FMS OVRD" buttons and VNAV modes are available on the Autoflight system. This is identical to MD-80s equipped with Honeywell AFMS.

AUXILIARY POWER UNIT

On the MD-80, the Auxiliary Power Unit (APU) is the Garrett GTCP85-98DHF. An Engine Control Unit (ECU) is optionally installed. APU gauges are different on ECU-equipped airplanes.

On the MD-90, a more capable AlliedSignal 131-9D APU is installed. The APU is controlled by an ECU. On non-EFD airplanes, APU gauges are very similar to those on ECU-equipped MD-80s. On EFD airplanes, APU information is only displayed on the System Display “ENG” page, and not on the overhead.

ELECTRICAL SYSTEM

APU AND EXTERNAL POWER

On the MD-80, APU and external power have their own connections to the left and right AC buses. There are switches to control each connection.

On the MD-90, APU and external power connect to the AC Tie bus “in-between” the tie switches. The tie switches can be moved to the “OPEN” position to prevent APU or external power from being connected to the respective AC bus.

The MD-90 is unique in that the external power switch is normally in the “ON” position, aside from when the airplane is powered down to cold and dark. The relay connecting external power to the tie bus is controlled by the Electrical Power Control Unit (EPCU).

BATTERIES

The MD-80 has two 14-volt batteries in series. The MD-90 has three 9-volt batteries in series with longer runtime.

EMERGENCY POWER

The MD-80 emergency power can be selected “OFF” or “ON”.

The MD-90 emergency power can be armed by moving the knob to the “ARM” position. If armed, emergency power will automatically turn on if power is lost to the emergency AC, emergency DC, or transfer DC buses.

ELECTRICAL POWER CONTROL UNIT

The MD-80 electrical system is controlled manually aside from a few automatic functions. There may be a break in power when transferring sources of various buses.

Some of the MD-90 electrical system is controlled by the Electrical Power Control Panel (EPCU). The EPCU will parallel sources to buses in order to prevent a break in power when transferring. The EPCU also controls the AC and DC bus ties as well as emergency power.

ENGINE GENERATORS

On the MD-80, engine electrical power is provided conventionally via an Integrated Drive Generator (IDG) and Constant Speed Drive (CSD).

There are not IDGs or CSDs on the MD-90. Engine electrical power is provided via a Variable Speed Constant Frequency (VSCF) system. The generators output 232-400V 800-1600Hz AC which is converted into DC power before being converted to 115V 400Hz AC.

Separate cooling is provided for the VSCFs in the E/E compartment in the front of the airplane.

TIE BUSES

The MD-80 tie bus is controlled by a single switch. The normal position is "AUTO".

The MD-90 has two switches controlling the tie, one for each side system. The normal position of both switches is "AUTO". APU and external power connect "in-between" these switches.

ENGINES

The MD-80 has two Pratt & Whitney JT8D-200 engines. The engines are controlled conventionally via cables from the throttles to the fuel control units. Reverse thrust is accomplished via clamshell buckets.

The MD-90 has two high-bypass, higher thrust, more efficient, International Aero Engines V2500 engines. The engines are controlled by signals from the throttles to Full Authority Digital Engine Control (FADEC) units installed on each engine. Reverse thrust is cascade-style. Reverse activation above 60 knots provide 1.3 EPR. Below 60 knots, only 1.07 EPR is available.

AUTOMATIC RESERVE THRUST

On the MD-80, if an engine fails during takeoff, the Automatic Reserve Thrust (ART) system automatically increases engine thrust on the remaining engine from normal to maximum takeoff thrust. ART is disarmed for FLEX takeoff.

On the MD-90, ART is not installed. This is not to be confused with Automatic Thrust Restoration (ATR), which is still available.

IGNITION

On the MD-80, ignition is not automatic. Ignition must be selected if desired.

On the MD-90, ignition is controlled automatically. It can be overridden "ON" if desired.

INSTRUMENTATION

The MD-80 has either round dials for engine instrumentation or the electronic Engine Display Panel (EDP) installed. There are no vibration indications.

The MD-90 has electronic instrumentation for the engines and has vibration indications.

N1 MODE

On the MD-80, Full Authority Digital Engine Control (FADEC) and thus N1 Mode is not installed.

On the MD-90, the normal FADEC control mode is EPR. N1 Mode can be activated if EPR indication is unreliable, or the system can automatically revert to N1 Mode if a failure occurs. N1 Mode is also used for reverse thrust. Thrust limitation and the Auto Thrust System (ATS) are not available in N1 Mode.

THRUST LIMITS

On the MD-80, thrust limits are computed by the Digital Flight Guidance System. On aircraft without Engine Display Panel (EDP), the active limit is displayed and selected on the Thrust Rating Indicator (TRI). On aircraft with EDP, the active limit is displayed on the EDP and selected on the Thrust Rating Panel (TRP). Separate "T/O" and "G/A" modes are available. The "CRZ" mode is available. The "EPR SEL" cutback mode is not installed. Thrust limit selection is mostly manual aside from certain automatic transitions to "G/A" mode.

On the MD-90, thrust limits are computed by the Full Authority Digital Engine Control (FADEC) units installed on each engine. There are small differences between standard and EFD MD-90s.

On the standard MD-90, the thrust limit operates similarly to MD-80s equipped with EDP. The "T/O" and "G/A" modes are combined into the "TOGA" mode. The "CRZ" mode and automatic cutback are only available on airplanes with the selectable 25K/28K thrust option. Automatic cutback can be selected on the MCDU TAKEOFF page. The "EPR SEL" cutback mode is installed on airplanes that do NOT have the selectable 25K/28K thrust option.

On the EFD MD-90, thrust limits are automatically selected by the Flight Management System (FMS), aside from the takeoff to climb thrust reduction. "T/O" and "G/A" are separate modes. The "CRZ" mode is available. The thrust limit mode can be overridden in the Multifunction Control and Display Unit (MCDU). Engine rating (25K or 28K), FLEX takeoff, and "EPR SEL" display via the MCDU THRUST LIMITS page. FLEX takeoff is only available with the 25K rating selected. Automatic cutback can be selected on the MCDU TAKEOFF 2/2 page.

When the "T/O" mode is active on the MD-90 EFD, the "CLB" mode can be armed by pulling the altitude knob when above 400 feet radio altitude. The "CLB" mode will automatically engage at the thrust reduction altitude. Further mode changes are automatic.

FLIGHT CONTROLS

ELEVATORS

The MD-80s elevators are normally manually flown by control tabs. If the elevators are commanded more than 10 degrees nose down, the elevator is hydraulically driven downward.

The MD-90s elevators are normally hydraulically driven. Manual reversion to control tabs is available if hydraulics fail or the ELEV CONT ELEV switch is selected "OFF".

PYLON FLAPS

The MD-80 does not have pylon flaps.

The MD-90 has flaps on the engine pylons which deflect downward hydraulically when the yoke reaches the full nose down position. This aids downward pitching motion during stalling conditions which may be stronger than on the MD-80 due to the heavier engines.

FUEL SYSTEM

ALTERNATE FUEL BURN

Alternate Fuel Burn (AFB) burns the fuel tanks in an alternating order when the center tank switches are in the "AUTO" position. The MD-90 EFD has a separate AFB switch.

Not all MD-80s have AFB installed.

MD-80 fuel schedule is as follows when AFB is enabled:

- Center tank to 10,000 pounds
- Main tanks to 4,000 pounds
- Center tank to empty
- Main tanks to empty

All MD-90s have AFB installed.

MD-90 fuel schedule is as follows when AFB is enabled:

- Center tank to 3,000 pounds
- Main tanks to 4,000 pounds
- Center tank to empty
- Main tanks to empty

FUEL HEAT AND RECIRCULATION

The MD-80 has manual fuel heat installed. A recirculation system is not installed.

The MD-90 does not have fuel heat. Return To Tank (RTT) recirculation is performed automatically instead.

HYDRAULIC SYSTEM

On the MD-80, the left and right engine pumps have “OFF”, “LO”, and “HI” positions.

On the MD-90, the pumps only have “OFF” and “ON” positions.

INSTRUMENTATION

This section will not describe what is installed in the MD-80. It will only describe what is changed on the MD-90.

STANDARD FLIGHT DECK

Engine Display Panel (EDP):

- Thrust rating (25K or 28K) is displayed only on airplanes with the selectable 25K/28K thrust option
- EPR limit is displayed separately for each engine
- EPR command shown on the EPR indicator
- N2 is displayed as a digital value only

Flight Management System (FMS):

- Honeywell AFMS is the only FMS option
- VNAV is installed on all airplanes

Systems Display Panel (SDP):

- TAT is displayed instead of RAT
- Engine vibration is displayed

Thrust Rating Panel (TRP):

- T/O and G/A buttons are replaced with TOGA.
- CRZ button is removed
- EPR SEL button is added

ENHANCED FLIGHT DECK

The Enhanced Flight Deck (EFD) contains several major and minor changes to the flightdeck to make it similar to the upcoming Advanced Common Flightdeck in design for the MD-95 (Boeing 717).

Major Changes:

- Six 8-inch Honeywell VIA Display Units (DU) replace conventional dials
- EFIS Control Panels (ECPs) are installed for the new Navigation Displays
- Display Control Panels (DCPs) is installed to control altimeter and minimums settings
- A new push-button overhead panel using the dark cockpit concept is installed
- A new pedestal containing new radios, audio panels, and DU controls is installed
- Exterior light switches and the transponder are relocated to the overhead
- TRP functionality is relocated to the Multifunction Control and Display Unit (MCDU)

Primary Flight Display (PFD):

- The Flight Mode Annunciator (FMA) is displayed at the top
- Airspeed, altitude, and vertical speed are displayed as a vertical tapes
- Heading is displayed on the bottom

Navigation Display (ND):

- Symbology differs, but is almost identical to the MD-11 and 717

Engine and Alert Display (EAD):

- EPR, N1, EGT, and N2 are displayed as arcs with a needle pointer
- EPR has rolling digits, N1, EGT, and N2 display value digitally
- EPR limits and thrust rating are displayed on the top
- EPR limit is displayed as a “V” symbol instead of “| |”
- Cautions and Warnings are displayed on the lower section

System Display (SD):

- Displays data for the respective systems on the AIR, ELEC, ENG, FUEL, and HYD pages
- Displays flight control and configuration information on the CONFIG page
- Caution and Warnings displayed on each system’s page and on CONSEQ, MISC, and STATUS pages
- Can display the ND if one of the other ND’s fail

PNEUMATIC SYSTEM

BLEED AND PACK INDICATIONS

On the MD-80, bleed pressure gauges are installed on the overhead. Pack flow gauges are not installed.

On the standard MD-90, bleed pressure gauges are not installed. Pack flow gauges are installed on the overhead.

On the MD-90 EFD, bleed pressure is displayed digitally on the synoptic. Pack flow is displayed on the synoptic as white (off), amber (low flow), or green (normal flow) impellers.

CABIN AIR RECIRCULATION FAN

On the MD-80, the cabin air recirculation fan only operates in flight.

On the MD-90, the cabin air recirculation fan operates as needed on the ground, and automatically in flight.

PNEUMATIC SYSTEM CONTROLLER

The MD-80 does not have a Pneumatic System Controller installed.

The MD-90 Pneumatic System Controller automatically adjusts system components to control pressure and temperatures based on requirements for air conditioning and ice protection. It also monitors the system and shuts down failing components if needed.

WARNING SYSTEMS

WARNING LAMPS

Some MD-80s have lamps for each caution or warning on forward section of the overhead panel.

Some MD-80s and all standard MD-90s have Electronic Overhead Alert Panel (EOAP) installed on the forward section of the overhead panel. MD-80s have a MONITOR light to advise of EOAP failures. MD-90s have a STATUS light instead that displays discrepancies or system information that requires no crew action.

The MD-90 EFD displays cautions and warnings on the bottom section of the Engine and Alert Display. They are also displayed on the respective System Display page.